

ILLUMINATED LIFE · A SETUP PLAN

A Home for *Everything*

How to set up the twelve fields on your laptop and your phone, and let Claude help you put your files and photos in order, safely and one step at a time.



TWELVE FIELDS · ONE STEWARD · NOTHING DELETED

What this plan is, and what it is not

A tidy laptop is not holiness. It is only a household in which things can be found, so that the steward is free for what matters.

The book describes twelve fields in three rings: the Person, the Household and the World. This plan gives each field one folder on your laptop, one album for your photos and one place on your phone, so that everything you hold has a home and you know where it is. Claude does the sorting with you. You decide; Claude proposes, moves and keeps a record.

The work follows the four movements of the model. **Receive:** see what is there, without changing anything. **Bless:** give each thing its place. **Spend:** move it there. **Return:** review it each season, and let go of what is no longer yours to keep.

Seven safety rules

1. **Back up first.** Nothing starts until a full backup exists (Time Machine to an external disk, or another complete copy) and you have checked that it finished.
2. **Nothing is deleted.** Claude does not delete files. Anything that looks unnecessary goes into a folder called *To review*, and you decide later.
3. **Duplicates are set aside, not removed.** Exact copies go into *Duplicates to review*. The first copy stays where it belongs.
4. **A list before a move.** For every folder, Claude first writes a plan: this file goes there, for this reason. Nothing moves until you say yes.
5. **Every move is written down.** A log file records where each file was and where it went, so any step can be undone.
6. **One folder at a time.** Start small, with Downloads or the Desktop. Check the result. Only then go on.
7. **Some places are never touched.** See the list on the next page.

What Claude does not touch

The system and application folders of the Mac (Library, Applications, System). Password managers, keychains and anything holding passwords or bank logins. The inside of the Photos library and of other app libraries (Music, Mail). Folders that belong to running projects with their own structure, such as a code repository or the *Imago Dei* folder, unless you ask for it by name. Claude also does not log in to accounts, change security settings or send anything on your behalf while sorting.

Honest limits. Claude can read file names, dates, types and, where you allow it, contents, and can sort from those. It will sometimes be unsure. Unsure files go to the Inbox, not to a guess. Claude works on the laptop through the Claude desktop app and only inside the folders you connect. It cannot reach into your phone. The phone follows the laptop through iCloud.

THE STRUCTURE

Twelve folders, three rings

One folder called **Illuminated Life**, kept in iCloud Drive so that the laptop and the phone see the same thing. The numbers keep the folders in the order of the model.

```
Illuminated Life/  
00 Inbox/  
01 Body/  
02 Mind/  
03 Soul/  
04 Heart/  
05 Time/  
06 Money/  
07 Work/  
08 Home/  
09 Creation/  
10 Speech/  
11 Beauty and Making/  
12 Mission/  
Archive/  
To review/  
Duplicates to review/  
Move log/
```

Inbox is the only place new things land. Once a week it is emptied into the twelve.

Archive holds finished years and closed matters, in the same twelve names, so nothing old clutters what is alive.

To review and **Duplicates to review** are waiting rooms. Only you empty them.

Move log holds the record of every move Claude made.

The colours follow the three rings: **ruby for the Person**, **sapphire for the Household**, **emerald for the World**. In Finder, give the folders the Red, Blue and Green tags so the rings show at a glance.

When a file fits two fields, ask what it is *for*. A receipt for a retreat is Money. The notes from the retreat are Soul. A photograph of your mother is Heart, even if it is beautiful.

FIELD	WHAT LIVES HERE	TYPICAL SUBFOLDERS
01 Body	Medical letters, test results, prescriptions, sport, sleep, recipes for health	Medical, Movement, Food
02 Mind	Courses, study notes, books and articles to read, reading lists	Study, Reading, Notes
03 Soul	Prayer texts, retreat notes, spiritual reading, the rule of life, the diary PDFs	Prayer, Retreats, Rule and Diary
04 Heart	Family papers, letters, cards, things about the people you love	Family, Friends, Letters
05 Time	Planning, calendars, season reviews, lists	Plans, Reviews
06 Money	Tax, bank statements, invoices, receipts, giving, pension, insurance payments	Tax (by year), Statements, Giving
07 Work	Contracts, CV, projects, clients, certificates	Projects, Admin, CV
08 Home	Lease or mortgage, manuals, warranties, household insurance, identity documents	House, Manuals, Documents
09 Creation	Garden, animals, travel in nature, what you buy and from whom	Garden, Journeys
10 Speech	What you have published or said: articles, talks, posts, important correspondence	Published, Talks, Correspondence
11 Beauty and Making	Your own art, design, music, writing in progress, and beauty you have collected	My work, Collected, Drafts
12 Mission	Service, volunteering, the foundation, Illuminated Life itself	Illuminated Life, Service, Foundation

The laptop

Step 0 · Prepare (you, about half an hour)

1. Make the backup and check that it completed.
2. Make sure iCloud Drive is on, and that there is enough free space in iCloud and on the disk.
3. Open the Claude desktop app and start a task. Connect **one** folder to begin with, for example Downloads.

Step 1 · Receive: the inventory (Claude, nothing moves)

Claude counts and describes what is in the folder: how many files, what kinds, how old, how large, which are exact duplicates. You receive a short report. This step changes nothing.

```
Please make an inventory of my Downloads folder. Do not move, rename or delete anything. Tell me how many files there are, of what kinds, from which years, how much space they use, and which are exact duplicates of each other. Then stop.
```

Step 2 · Bless: the proposal (Claude proposes, you decide)

Claude creates the empty *Illuminated Life* structure and writes a proposal: a table with every file, the field it would go to, and the reason. Files it is unsure about are marked for the Inbox. You read it, correct it and approve it.

```
Create the Illuminated Life folder structure from my plan (00 Inbox, 01 Body ... 12 Mission, Archive, To review, Duplicates to review, Move log). Then propose where each file from Downloads should go, as a table with the reason. Put anything you are unsure about in 00 Inbox. Do not move anything yet. Never delete anything.
```

Step 3 · Spend: the move (Claude, with a log)

After your yes, Claude moves the files, never overwriting a file that already exists, and writes the move log. Exact duplicates go to *Duplicates to review*. Then it checks that the number of files before and after is the same.

```
I approve the proposal with these changes: [...]. Move the files now. Never overwrite and never delete. Put exact duplicates in Duplicates to review. Write every move (from, to, date) into a file in Move log. When you are done, confirm that the count of files before and after is equal, and tell me how to undo it.
```

Step 4 · Repeat, in this order

Downloads, then Desktop, then Documents, then older folders and external disks. One at a time, each with its own inventory, proposal and move. Leave application folders and project folders with their own structure where they are; a shortcut (alias) to them inside the right field is enough.

Step 5 · Return: the review

When everything has a home, look through *To review* and *Duplicates to review* yourself. What you delete, you delete; Claude does not. Move finished years into *Archive*. Then make a new backup.

The photos

Photographs are memory, and memory deserves more care than paperwork. So here the rule is stricter: the photo library itself is never rearranged. Order is added on top of it, with albums.

On a Mac and an iPhone, your photographs live in the Photos library and usually in iCloud Photos. That library is a single protected package. Moving files in or out of it by hand can damage it. So the twelve fields come to your photos as **albums**, not as folders. An album is only a list. A photo can be in several albums, and removing it from an album does not delete it.

What to set up

1. In Photos, make a folder called **Illuminated Life** and inside it twelve albums with the same names and numbers as the folders. Photos has no colours for albums; the numbers keep the rings together.
2. Most people will fill only some of them. Heart (people), Creation (nature and journeys), Beauty and Making (art, churches, your own work), Home, Mission and Soul (pilgrimages, feasts, sacraments) usually hold nearly everything.
3. Use what Photos already does well: People, Places, Memories, and the built-in Duplicates album, which merges copies without losing the best version. Review that album yourself.
4. Screenshots, receipts and scans are paperwork, not memories. Export the ones worth keeping to the right field folder, then decide yourself whether to remove them from Photos.

How Claude can help

For **loose photo files** that are not in the Photos library (on the Desktop, in Downloads, on an old disk), Claude works as in the laptop steps: inventory, proposal, move, log. It can group them by date and place, find exact duplicates, and suggest a field for each group. It can then leave them ready for you to import into Photos.

For **the Photos library itself**, Claude can guide you album by album, or, if you allow it to control the Photos app on screen while you watch, create the albums and add photos you point out. It should not delete, merge or edit photos there. Go year by year, a little each week. There is no hurry.

I have a folder of loose photos at [folder]. Make an inventory only: how many, from which years, which are exact duplicates. Then propose groups by date and place and which of my twelve albums each group fits. Do not move, rename, edit or delete any photo.

Before any photo work: check that iCloud Photos has finished syncing and that the backup includes the Photos library. If the Mac is set to "Optimise Mac Storage", the full originals are in iCloud and not on the laptop, and a local backup alone does not hold them.

The phone

The phone does not need its own system. It needs to show the same one.

WHERE	WHAT TO DO
Files	Because <i>Illuminated Life</i> is in iCloud Drive, it appears in the Files app. Add it to Favourites. Save new documents and scans to 00 Inbox .
Photos	The twelve albums appear by themselves through iCloud Photos. Add a photo to its album when you take it, or once a week.
Home screen	Open the <i>Illuminated Life</i> app in Safari, choose Share, then Add to Home Screen. Keep it on the first page, with the prayer app you use (Laudate, Divine Office, Ascension or Hallow) beside it.
Notes	One folder, <i>Illuminated Life</i> , with a note called Inbox for things that come to mind. If you like, one note per field; no more.
Calendar	Import the anchors from the app (Rule, then the calendar export) into your one calendar.
Quiet	A Focus for prayer and for sleep, and the phone charging outside the bedroom. This is the Body field's first step.
Claude	The Claude app on the phone lets you continue a conversation and ask where something is. The sorting itself happens on the laptop.

Keeping it alive

Each week, on the day you review your Rule: empty 00 Inbox into the twelve, and add the week's photos to their albums. Ten minutes. You can ask Claude to propose where the Inbox files go.

Each season, with the review of the twelve fields: look at which folders grew and which stayed empty. An empty folder is not a failure. It may be a question. Move closed matters to Archive, empty the review folders, and check the backup.

Each year: start a new year's subfolder where years matter (Money, Work), and archive the old one.

A word to keep

Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing may be lost. (John 6:12)

This plan is a practical aid that accompanies the book *Illuminated: The Image of God, Embodied*. It is not a spiritual practice in itself and carries no authority. Product details (iCloud, Photos, the Claude app) change over time; check what your own devices show before each step.